

Steven McDonald

Senior Software Engineer · UI/UX Technical Lead

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Front-end and design lead with 5 years shipping healthcare software at scale. Own the full arc from user research to production architecture on a platform serving 4,000+ monthly clinical users across the VA hospital system.

EXPERIENCE

HealthLevel — Mountain View, CA · Radiology data management SaaS · 50 employees

UI/UX Technical Lead - September 2022 – Present

I own the front-end architecture and design practice for Foundations, a TypeScript, C#, and MySQL platform that reduces administrative overhead and improves scheduling for radiology departments. Deployed across a dozen VA VISNs and 3 private radiology groups, serving 4,175 monthly users and processing 700,000+ imaging orders per year.

- **Led design and delivery of a tele-stroke clinical portal** for a new enterprise customer, owning the client design relationship end to end — requirements, mockups, moderated usability sessions, and front-end implementation of patient records, case detail, follow-up, and case history modules
- **Architected a strangler-pattern compatibility layer** allowing React components to render inside the legacy front end — enabling incremental migration of a live production product with zero feature freeze
- **Managed an international team of 3 engineers** across US and India time zones with no attrition over two years; interviewed 12 candidates, hired 3, and owned onboarding and mentorship
- **Evaluated and selected the state management architecture** (Redux Toolkit, RTK Query, Zustand), eliminating data-fetching boilerplate and standardizing server state handling across the codebase; migration to React and a functional component architecture cut compile times, raised Lighthouse scores from 32 to 80, and widened the hiring pool
- **Designed API structures** for internal tools and customer-facing portals, defining endpoint structure and data contracts in collaboration with backend engineers
- **Established UI and UX design guidelines and a research-to-prototype pipeline** adopted company-wide — user research, wireframing, Figma prototyping, and moderated usability testing — as the standard process for all new feature development
- **Led WCAG and Section 508 compliance**, ensuring we follow the accessibility standards required to hold federal VA contracts
- **Built and maintained HIPAA-compliant interfaces** handling PHI across clinical and scheduling workflows, and integrated an internal AI agent to accelerate customer-facing work
- **Introduced automated test coverage** for the React codebase and built internal tooling to accelerate delivery, including a forms builder and a database mapping tool

Front End Engineer - August 2021 – September 2022

- **Ran user interviews and shadowing sessions** with radiology staff to identify workflow friction, then redesigned core flows to remove 50% of required clicks and reduce API calls by 30% — cutting wait times and repetitive-strain load for staff working high-volume daily shifts
- **Designed and shipped user-facing features** including data visualizations, quick insight boards, a database mapping update tool, and a night mode that reduced eye fatigue on overnight radiology shifts

On Me Gifting — San Francisco, CA · Gift card technology startup

Consultant - August 2023 – October 2023

- Designed and built the first generation of the company's UI framework in Next.js and Tailwind CSS at onme.com
- Shipped cross-platform user features for Android and iOS in React Native

PROJECTS

learnanythingwithai.com - April – August 2026

Built an HTML and JavaScript engine for generating and running LLM-authored courses on any subject — a strict course schema, reusable components, and a course prompt builder

EDUCATION

Cornell University — Ithaca, NY · B.S. Computer Science, cum laude December 2019

Lorenzo de Medici Institute — Florence, Italy · Fine Arts and Design Spring 2018, Spring 2020